



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we blanch vegetables before freezing them at home?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Blanching stops enzyme actions that cause loss of flavor, color, and texture.

FUN FACT

Blanching is like giving veggies a quick hot bath before freezing!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What temperature should your freezer be to keep frozen fruits and vegetables at best quality?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

0°F (-18°C) or lower

FUN FACT

Freezers have to be really cold to keep food tasty and safe!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is freezer burn, and why should we avoid it?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Freezer burn happens when air dries out frozen food, making it tough and flavorless.

FUN FACT

Freezer burn looks like white, dry spots but doesn't mean food is unsafe!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What kind of packaging helps prevent freezer burn when freezing food?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Packaging that keeps out air, like vacuum-sealed bags or tightly wrapped plastic.

FUN FACT

Less air in your food package means fewer ice crystals and better flavor!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why should you leave space at the top of containers when freezing food in jars or plastic boxes?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because water expands as it freezes and can break the container if there is no space.

FUN FACT

Frozen water takes up more room than liquid water-that's why ice floats!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Which of these foods does not freeze well and may have a bad texture after freezing?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Lettuce

FUN FACT

Leafy salads get soggy if frozen because ice crystals break their leaves!

Source: SP 50-766 Foods that do not freeze well



Q

What should you do with seafood like shrimp before freezing to keep it fresh?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Wrap each piece tightly in plastic wrap, then place in a freezer bag.

FUN FACT

Wrapping seafood tightly helps stop air from drying it out in the freezer.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Tweens (10–14)

Q

How often might you need to reglaze frozen fish stored with an ice coating in the freezer?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Every 5 to 6 weeks

FUN FACT

Ice glazing helps protect fish from freezer burn like a shiny jacket!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What happens if you open the freezer door a lot when storing frozen food?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Warm air enters, causing ice crystals to grow and food quality to drop.

FUN FACT

Frequent freezer door openings make ice crystals grow bigger and food dry out!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Tweens (10–14)

Q

How long can most frozen fruits and vegetables keep their best quality in the freezer?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

8 to 12 months

FUN FACT

Frozen fruits and veggies stay tasty for almost a year if kept cold enough!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

**If the power goes out,
how long can a full
freezer keep food frozen if
you don't open the door?**



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

About 2 days

FUN FACT

A full freezer acts like a big ice box and stays cold longer than one half full!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When a grown-up labels frozen food with the date before putting it in the freezer, why is that helpful?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

So they can tell how long the food has been frozen and use it while it tastes its best.

FUN FACT

A label with the date can stop food from being thrown away because no one remembers when it was frozen!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What must you avoid storing potatoes near because it makes them sprout faster?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Apples

FUN FACT

Potatoes sprout faster if near apples because apples release a gas called ethylene!

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide



Twens (10–14)

Q

What helps a root cellar keep humidity high for storing vegetables longer?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

An earthen or dirt floor

FUN FACT

Dirt floors sneak moisture into the air to keep root veggies happy and crisp!

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide



Twens (10–14)

Q

What should you do if frozen vegetables thaw and reach above 40°F (5°C)?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Do not refreeze and avoid eating them because bacteria could grow.

FUN FACT

Once veggies thaw above 40°F, they could get unsafe even if they look fine!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we freeze fruits in sugar syrup or sugar pack instead of plain when possible?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Sugar helps them keep color, flavor, and texture better during freezing.

FUN FACT

A sweet syrup coat protects fruits from freezer damage like a candy shield!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What's the best way to thaw frozen seafood safely at home?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

In the refrigerator or under cold running water

FUN FACT

Slow thawing keeps seafood safe and tasty, just like taking a gentle bath!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Tweens (10–14)

Q

How does vacuum packaging help keep frozen food better?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

It removes air which slows down oxidation and freezer burn.

FUN FACT

Less air means less freezer burn and better-tasting food later!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

When you watch a grown-up pack vegetables for the freezer, why do they put them into small bags or pieces instead of one big chunk?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because small pieces freeze faster and you can take out just the right amount when you want to use some.

FUN FACT

Did you know that small pieces of vegetables freeze faster and stay fresh longer than big clumps?

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



Q

When you watch a grown-up store vegetables in a cool root cellar, which veggies do they cover with damp sawdust to help them stay fresh and crunchy for a long time?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Carrots and beets

FUN FACT

The damp sawdust keeps carrots and beets snug and crunchy while they rest in the cool root cellar!

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide